



FUEL WATCH

POLESTAR INSIGHTS

REPORTING PERIOD: 8 SEPTEMBER 2026 - 14 SEPTEMBER 2026

EXECUTIVE SUMMARY

The principal market move is upward pressure across crude and aviation fuel. Crude benchmarks rose against the supplied references; Aviation fuel rose within the reporting period.

The most significant responses came where producers and major buyers adjusted export, import or loading posture - resetting local economics and contract pass-through assumptions for the next cycle.

FAST FACTS

BRENT CRUDE - ICE BRENT FRONT-MONTH

107.8 USD/bbl

+11.9% 7d

ICE Brent front-month (Yahoo Finance)

As of 14 Sep 2026

WTI CRUDE - NYMEX WTI FRONT-MONTH

102.9 USD/bbl

+12.5% 7d

NYMEX WTI front-month (Yahoo Finance)

As of 14 Sep 2026

JET FUEL

4.340 USD/gal

+5.4% 7d

U.S. Gulf Coast kerosene-type - EIA / FRED

As of 9 Sep 2026



JET FUEL PRICE TRAJECTORY

U.S. Gulf Coast kerosene-type jet fuel (USD/gal)

Latest 09 Sep: **4.34** USD/gal



U.S. Gulf Coast kerosene-type jet fuel, 6 observations from 01 Sep to 09 Sep.

Jet fuel latest available 9 Sep 2026 (daily EIA U.S. Gulf Coast series, publication trails the crude close); Brent and WTI run to 14 Sep 2026 (the period end).

MARKET READ

Brent crude - ICE Brent front-month stood at 107.78 USD/bbl. This increases near-term procurement and surcharge pressure. WTI crude - NYMEX WTI front-month stood at 102.89 USD/bbl. This increases near-term procurement and surcharge pressure. Jet fuel stood at 4.34 USD/gal and was rising over the reporting period. This increases near-term procurement and surcharge pressure.

Brent is sitting around 107.78 USD/bbl and WTI around 102.89 USD/bbl, which puts the crude complex in elevated territory rather than a transient spike. The jet fuel series is rising within the reporting period, with the observed figure at 4.340 USD/gal on 9 Sep 2026 versus 4.130 on 8 Sep 2026 (+5.1%).

Some reporting-period benchmarks rose. If suppliers pass those increases through, they could affect freight rates, generator running costs, staff movement and supplier pricing.

SITUATION

Market-price pressure is upward on crude and refined products. The evidence records fuel shortages in at least one market. Refinery or production disruption is confirmed; actual output loss could affect regional product supply or crack spreads. Producer and buyer responses - export shifts, import tenders or cross-border product flows - are reshaping who supplies whom. Route and chokepoint events are confirmed; transit time and war-risk premium could rise if passage is constrained.

WHAT HAPPENED

On 8 September 2026 in Strait of Hormuz, a fuel-supply development was reported, with possible significance for regional availability and delivered cost.

On 8 September 2026 in Saudi Arabia, refinery or terminal disruption curtailed regional product output.

On 9 September 2026 in Strait of Hormuz, a fuel-route development was reported, with possible significance for transit time and delivered cost.

On 12 September 2026 in Saudi Arabia, refinery or terminal disruption curtailed regional product output.

On 12 September 2026, reporting flagged potential Iran sanctions and continued naval pressure in the Strait of Hormuz without a confirmed closure.

On 13 September 2026 in Saudi Arabia, refinery or terminal disruption curtailed regional product output.

On 13 September 2026, a commercial vessel was attacked while transiting the Strait of Hormuz, killing crew and disrupting passage.

On 13 September 2026, Russia's domestic fuel shortage spread across multiple regions after refinery strikes and distribution strain.

On 13 September 2026 in Saudi Arabia, refinery or terminal disruption curtailed regional product output.

On 13 September 2026 in Ukraine, fuel-availability pressure was reported, with direct significance for local access and commercial offtake.

OPERATIONAL READ

The main themes right now are chokepoint pressure and tanker-route disruption; fuel shortages; refinery disruption and supply-side outage. Dependent fuel movement could be forced onto longer, costlier routes if the reported disruption constrains transit.

The reported operational themes are most visible in Saudi Arabia, Russia and Ukraine.

REGIONAL HIGHLIGHTS

Saudi Arabia is the clearest pressure point right now. A refinery-side supply disruption was reported there. A confirmed loss of refinery output could tighten regional product balances and downstream pricing.

Ukraine is a secondary but credible concern. A material fuel-market development was reported there. Forecourt shortages could put road transport, staff movement and generator runtime under immediate continuity pressure.

MARKET AND OPERATOR RESPONSES

ACTOR	CATEGORY	ACTION	OPERATIONAL READ
Aviation sector	Buyer action	Russia's domestic fuel shortage spread across multiple regions after refinery strikes and distribution strain 13 Sept 2026	Aviation cost pressure: fuel expense is feeding into airline operating economics; watch schedule, surcharge and capacity responses.
Saudi Arabia infrastructure operator	Infrastructure / routing action	Refinery or terminal disruption curtailed regional product output 12 Sept 2026	Rerouting adds voyage time and freight cost to affected fuel cargoes; landed cost and delivery schedules on the corridor are the direct exposure.

WHAT MATTERS

Russia carries the greatest business exposure. Changes in jet-fuel prices could affect aviation surcharges and route profitability; timing depends on airline pricing and fuel contracts.

A second material issue is developing around Saudi Arabia. Resumed Saudi loading adds near-term crude availability to the reported market.

The main risk is fuel-route disruption and higher delivered cost. The principal exposure is road fuel distribution in Saudi Arabia; the near-term direction is upward.

IMPLICATIONS FOR BUSINESS

Review delivered-cost assumptions, supplier terms and contingency volumes for exposed fuel-dependent operations. Revisit bulk-fuel and aviation surcharge pass-through clauses now - elevated Brent, WTI or jet observations typically reach invoices on the next billing cycle, not the current one. Where reporting of fuel shortages persists, keep road-transport and commercial-allocation conversations live with suppliers. Check on-site diesel or LPG stock and generator runtime assumptions in markets reporting fuel shortages. Where Gulf, Hormuz or Red Sea routing matters, test war-risk, transit-time and landed-cost assumptions against potential route changes.

POLESTAR VIEW

Fuel risk is High. Prices are rising. Exposure sits with fuel-dependent transport, critical-site replenishment and contracts that pass delivered-cost changes through quickly. The current evidence combines market-price pressure with physical supply and routing constraints, so the assessment is not based on price movement alone. Protect critical-site stocks, replenishment cycles and delivery schedules. Tighter allocation, longer delivery times or a clear easing in physical constraints would justify revising the near-term view.

WATCH NEXT

Watch for a confirmed change in transit availability. Watch for confirmed operational follow-through at Russia, especially any reported change in fuel availability, routing or cost. Watch for confirmed operational follow-through at Saudi Arabia, especially any reported change in fuel availability, routing or cost. Watch for fresh advisories, vessel reroutes and any naval movement that signals escalation. Monitor confirmed refinery restart dates, terminal throughput and any extension of the outage, because prolonged output loss would tighten product availability and lengthen replenishment cycles.

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